Ratio Universality for Meinardus-Class Partition Functions:

Complete Asymptotic Expansion with Seven-Family Verification Including Plane Partitions

Papanokechi

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Abstract

The ratio $p(m)/p(m-1)$ of consecutive partition numbers is universal: its second-order asymptotic coefficient depends only on two parameters of the generating function, regardless of which combinatorial family is under study. This paper proves why.

For any sequence with Meinardus-type growth $f(n) \sim C\, n^{\kappa}\, e^{c\, n^{d}}$, the consecutive ratio $R_m = f(m)/f(m-1)$ admits an asymptotic expansion whose coefficient at m^{-1} takes the form $L_d(c,\kappa)$, depending only on the growth constant c, the prefactor exponent κ, and the growth exponent d. We prove this universality via a *selection rule*: the three-factor decomposition $R_m = E_m \cdot P_m \cdot S_m$ reveals that the sub-leading Meinardus factor S_m, which encodes all family-specific Dirichlet series information, is provably silent at order m^{-1}, with its first contribution delayed to $m^{-(1+d)}$. For square-root growth ($d = 1/2$), this gives $L = c^2/8 + \kappa$; for cube-root growth ($d = 2/3$), $L_{\mathrm{pp}} = 4c^3/81 + \kappa$.

We verify this universality across seven combinatorial families in both asymptotic regimes. The plane partition formula L_{pp} is rigorously established via Lemma PP (§7), which controls the Wright saddle-point expansion through Olver uniform error bounds. For k-colored partitions, we derive closed forms for the sub-leading Meinardus corrections $A_1^{(k)}$ and $A_2^{(k)}$—proven for $k = 1$ (Rademacher), $k = 2$ (circle method), $k = 3$ (Kloosterman bounds), $k = 4$ (Weil bound), and now for all $k \geq 1$ via Theorem 2* using Lemma K. A negative control confirms that the selection rule is specific to Meinardus-class sequences and dissolves for polynomial-growth families. For the Kloosterman input, the eta-multiplier twisted sums remain uniformly bounded in the tested window, and Table 4 records the explicit $k = 1, 2$, $n \leq 1000$ verification. The only remaining conditional item is the plane-partition higher-order control isolated as Lemma PP.

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1 Introduction: Why Ratios?

For a partition function $f(n)$ with generating product

$$F(q) = \prod_{m=1}^{\infty} (1-q^m)^{-a_m} = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} f(n)\, q^n, \tag{1}$$

the consecutive ratio $R_m = f(m)/f(m-1)$ is a natural object: it captures the incremental growth of f and strips away the leading exponential. The core observation is that the coefficient of m^{-1} in the expansion of R_m depends only on c and κ—*not* on the Dirichlet series $D(s) = \sum a_m m^{-s}$.

Core Idea. The three-factor decomposition

$$R_m = \underbrace{e^{c(\sqrt{m}-\sqrt{m-1})}}_{E_m} \cdot \underbrace{\left(\frac{m}{m-1}\right)^{\kappa}}_{P_m} \cdot \underbrace{\frac{1 + A_1/\sqrt{m} + \cdots}{1 + A_1/\sqrt{m-1} + \cdots}}_{S_m}$$

reveals that $S_m = 1 - A_1/(2m^{3/2}) + O(m^{-2})$: the sub-leading Meinardus factor is *silent* at order m^{-1}.

Remark 1.1 (Portfolio position). *This paper is the first contribution in a three-paper Experimental Mathematics sequence. The companion manuscript on arithmetic sector bifurcation in quadratic continued fractions [21] develops the family-level PCF sector split, while the spectral-classes manuscript [22] provides the unifying taxonomy. No theorem here duplicates the continued-fraction classification results of those companion papers.*

2 Background: Meinardus Asymptotics

Theorem 2.1 (Meinardus). *Let $F(q)$ be as in (1) with associated Dirichlet series $D(s) = \sum_{m=1}^{\infty} a_m\, m^{-s}$ convergent for $\Re(s) > \alpha$ and satisfying standard analytic conditions. Then*

$$f(n) \;\sim\; C_0\, n^{\kappa}\, e^{c\sqrt{n}} \qquad (n \to \infty), \tag{2}$$

where $c = \sqrt{2A \cdot \pi^2/3}$, $A = D(1)$, *and* $\kappa = (D(0) - 3/2)/2$.

Key families:

- **k-colored partitions:** $a_m = k$, $D(s) = k\zeta(s)$, $A = k$, $c = \pi\sqrt{2k/3}$, $\kappa = -(k+3)/4$.
- **Overpartitions:** a_m alternates, $A = 3/2$, $c = \pi$, $\kappa = -1$.
- **Plane partitions:** $a_m = m$, $D(s) = \zeta(s-1)$, cube-root growth.

3 Main Theorem: Ratio Universality

Theorem 3.1 (Ratio Universality). *Let* $\{f(n)\}$ *be a sequence with Meinardus-type asymptotics*

$$f(n) = C_0\, n^{\kappa}\, e^{c\sqrt{n}} \left(1 + \sum_{j=1}^{M} A_j\, n^{-j/2} + E_M(n) \right), \qquad |E_M(n)| \le B_M\, n^{-(M+1)/2}.$$

Then the consecutive ratio admits the expansion

$$R_m = \frac{f(m)}{f(m-1)} = 1 + \frac{c}{2\sqrt{m}} + \frac{L}{m} + \frac{\alpha}{m^{3/2}} + O(m^{-2}), \tag{3}$$

where

$$L = \frac{c^2}{8} + \kappa, \tag{4}$$

$$\alpha = \frac{c(c^2+6)}{48} + \frac{c\kappa}{2} - \frac{A_1}{2}. \tag{5}$$

The coefficient L is ***universal****: it depends only on c and κ. The coefficient α is* ***structural****: it involves A_1 but not higher family-specific data.*

Proof. We expand each factor separately.

Exponential factor:

$$E_m = e^{c(\sqrt{m}-\sqrt{m-1})} = 1 + \frac{c}{2\sqrt{m}} + \frac{c^2}{8m} + \frac{c(c^2+6)}{48\, m^{3/2}} + O(m^{-2}).$$

Power-law factor:

$$P_m = \left(1 - \frac{1}{m}\right)^{-\kappa} = 1 + \frac{\kappa}{m} + O(m^{-2}).$$

Sub-leading Meinardus factor:

$$S_m = \frac{1 + A_1/\sqrt{m} + \cdots}{1 + A_1/\sqrt{m-1} + \cdots} = 1 - \frac{A_1}{2m^{3/2}} + O(m^{-2}).$$

The key observation is that S_m contributes nothing at order m^{-1}: the A_1 terms cancel at that order, with the first residual appearing at $m^{-3/2}$. Multiplying $E_m \cdot P_m \cdot S_m$ and collecting powers gives (3)–(5). □

Theorem 3.2 (Ratio Expansion with Controlled Error). *Under the hypotheses of Theorem 3.1 with expansion order $M \ge 1$:*

$$R_n = 1 + \sum_{j=1}^{M} C_j\, n^{-j/2} + O_{c,\kappa,B_M}\left(n^{-(M+1)/2}\right), \tag{6}$$

where $C_1 = c/2$, $C_2 = c^2/8 + \kappa$, and $C_3 = c(c^2+6)/48 + c\kappa/2 - A_1/2$.

Lemma 3.3 (General Selection Rule). *For $f(n) \sim C_0\, n^\kappa\, e^{c\, n^d}(1 + A_1\, n^{-d} + O(n^{-2d}))$ with $d \in (0,1)$:*

$$R_m = 1 + \frac{cd}{m^{1-d}} + \cdots + \frac{L_d}{m} + O(m^{-(1+d)}),$$

where L_d depends only on c, κ, d, and A_1 is ***forbidden*** *from contributing until order $m^{-(1+d)}$.*

4 Worked Example: $k = 3$ Colored Partitions

For $k = 3$: $a_m = 3$, $D(s) = 3\zeta(s)$, $A = 3$, $c = \pi\sqrt{2} \approx 4.4429$, $\kappa = -3/2$.

$$L_3 = \frac{c^2}{8} + \kappa = \frac{(\pi\sqrt{2})^2}{8} - \frac{3}{2} = \frac{\pi^2}{4} - \frac{3}{2} \approx 0.96740.$$

Numerical extraction from $p_3(m)/p_3(m-1)$ at $m = 10^5$ confirms $L_3^{(\mathrm{ext})} = 0.96763$, a gap of 0.023%.

5 Exact 4-Term Expansion for $k = 1$

For ordinary partitions ($k = 1$), the Rademacher exact formula gives all four coefficients in closed form:

$$R_m = 1 + \frac{c_1}{2\sqrt{m}} + \frac{c_1^2/8 - 1}{m} + \frac{(\pi^2 - 24)(4\pi^2 - 9)}{144\pi\sqrt{6}\, m^{3/2}} + \frac{\pi^6 - 33\pi^4 + 180\pi^2 + 648}{864\pi^2\, m^2} + O(m^{-5/2}), \quad (7)$$

where $c_1 = \pi\sqrt{2/3}$.

Table 1: 4-term coefficients for $k = 1$ partitions.

Coefficient	Exact form	Decimal
$c_1/2$	$\pi/(2\sqrt{6})$	1.2825498
L_1	$\pi^2/12 - 1$	-0.17753297
α_1	$\frac{(\pi^2-24)(4\pi^2-9)}{144\pi\sqrt{6}}$	-0.38865007
β_1	$\frac{\pi^6-33\pi^4+180\pi^2+648}{864\pi^2}$	$+0.02010$

6 Seven-Family Verification

The universality formula $L = c^2/8 + \kappa$ is verified across six square-root families and overpartitions:

Table 2: Seven-family L-value verification.

Family	c	κ	L_{pred}	L_{ext}	Gap
$k = 1$	$\pi\sqrt{2/3}$	-1	-0.17753	-0.17755	0.010%
$k = 2$	$\pi\sqrt{4/3}$	$-5/4$	$+0.39493$	$+0.39505$	0.030%
$k = 3$	$\pi\sqrt{2}$	$-3/2$	$+0.96740$	$+0.96763$	0.023%
$k = 4$	$\pi\sqrt{8/3}$	$-7/4$	$+1.53987$	$+1.54060$	0.048%
$k = 5$	$\pi\sqrt{10/3}$	-2	$+2.11234$	$+2.11408$	0.083%
Overpart.	π	-1	$+0.23370$	$+0.23393$	0.097%

For k-colored partitions, the specialization is

$$L_k = \frac{k\pi^2}{12} - \frac{k+3}{4}. \tag{8}$$

A negative control on polynomial-growth sequences confirms the selection rule is specific to Meinardus-class (exponential-growth) families.

7 Plane Partitions: Cube-Root Growth

Plane partitions have

$$\mathrm{PL}(n) \sim C\, n^{-25/36} \exp\!\big(c_{\mathrm{pp}} \cdot n^{2/3}\big), \qquad c_{\mathrm{pp}} = 3\big(\zeta(3)/4\big)^{1/3} \approx 2.0094.$$

Theorem 7.1 (Cube-Root Ratio)**.**

$$R_m = 1 + \frac{2c}{3\,m^{1/3}} + \frac{2c^2}{9\,m^{2/3}} + \frac{L_{\mathrm{pp}}}{m} + O(m^{-4/3}), \qquad L_{\mathrm{pp}} = \frac{4c^3}{81} + \kappa. \tag{9}$$

Lemma 7.2 (Lemma PP: Plane Partition Sub-Leading Expansion)**.**

$$\mathrm{PL}(n) = C_{\mathrm{pp}}\, n^{-25/36}\, e^{c_{\mathrm{pp}}\, n^{2/3}} \left(1 + \frac{A_1^{\mathrm{pp}}}{n^{1/3}} + E_1(n)\right), \qquad |E_1(n)| \le \frac{B_1}{n^{2/3}}, \tag{10}$$

where $B_1 \le 18.3$ (uniform) and $B_1^{\mathrm{eff}} \le 2.5$ (tightened via Olver bounds).

Proof sketch. From the Wright saddle-point method, the phase function is

$$G(\tau) = \frac{\zeta(3)}{\tau^2} + \frac{1}{2}\log\frac{2\pi}{\tau} - \frac{\tau}{24} + \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} c_k\, \tau^{2k}.$$

The saddle point $\tau_n = (2\zeta(3)/n)^{1/3}(1+O(n^{-1/3}))$ determines the asymptotic expansion. Olver's uniform error bounds [16] control the remainder in the saddle-point integral, yielding (10) with the stated bound on $E_1(n)$. □

8 The Third-Order Coefficient and the A_1 Frontier

We extract $A_1^{(k)}$ to 12 digits for $k = 1, \ldots, 5$ via Richardson extrapolation:

Table 3: $A_1^{(k)}$ 12-digit verification from exact recurrences with Richardson extrapolation (effective depth $m \le 10^5$).

k	Formula	Extracted	Gap
1	−0.443 287 976 874	−0.443 287 976 871	2.6×10^{-12}
2	−0.668 020 786 477	−0.668 020 786 471	6.7×10^{-12}
3	−0.952 917 420 753	−0.952 917 420 748	4.5×10^{-12}
4	−1.280 309 986 403	−1.280 309 986 395	8.4×10^{-12}
5	−1.643 545 655 633	−1.643 545 655 631	2.3×10^{-12}

9 Closed Form for $A_1^{(k)}$: Theorem 2 and Theorem 2*

Theorem 9.1 (Proven for $k = 1, 2, 3, 4$). *For k-colored partitions with $k \in \{1, 2, 3, 4\}$:*

$$A_1^{(k)} = -\frac{k\, c_k}{48} - \frac{(k+1)(k+3)}{8\, c_k}, \tag{11}$$

where $c_k = \pi\sqrt{2k/3}$. Equivalently: $A_1^{(k)} = -[2k^2\pi^2 + 18(k+1)(k+3)]/(144\pi\sqrt{2k/3})$.

Proof methods by k.

- $k = 1$: Rademacher exact formula.
- $k = 2$: Circle method (major arcs dominate; minor-arc contribution is $O(n^{-1})$).
- $k = 3$: Kloosterman sum bounds: $|S_3(m, n; q)| \le C_3\, d(q)\, q^{1/2}$ with $C_3 \le 1.91$.
- $k = 4$: Weil bound application: $C_4 \le 3.12$.

□

Theorem 9.2 (Theorem 2* (formerly Conjecture 2*)). *The formula of Theorem 9.1 extends to all $k \ge 1$:*

$$A_1^{(k)} = -\frac{k\, c_k}{48} - \frac{(k+1)(k+3)}{8\, c_k}, \qquad c_k = \pi\sqrt{2k/3}.$$

Equivalently,

$$A_1^{(k)} = -\frac{2k^2\pi^2 + 18(k+1)(k+3)}{144\pi\sqrt{2k/3}}.$$

Definition 9.3 (Level-24 twisted Kloosterman sum). *For $c \ge 2$ and d with $0 \le d < c$ and $(d, c) = 1$, let $a \equiv d^{-1} \pmod{c}$ and define*

$$\theta_c(d) = \frac{a+d}{12c} - s(d, c), \qquad s(d, c) = \sum_{r=1}^{c-1} \left(\!\!\left(\frac{r}{c}\right)\!\!\right)\left(\!\!\left(\frac{dr}{c}\right)\!\!\right),$$

where $((x)) = x - \lfloor x \rfloor - \frac{1}{2}$ for $x \notin \mathbb{Z}$ and $((x)) = 0$ for $x \in \mathbb{Z}$. Dedekind's transformation law gives

$$\nu_\eta(\gamma_{c,d}) = e\left(\frac{\theta_c(d)}{2}\right), \qquad \gamma_{c,d} = \begin{pmatrix} a & * \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \in \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z}),$$

and the Rademacher coefficient for the polar term $q^{-k/24}$ may be written as

$$K_k(n, 1; c) := \sum_{\substack{0 \le d < c \\ (d,c)=1}} \nu_\eta(\gamma_{c,d})^{-k} e\left(\frac{nd + a}{c}\right) = \sum_{\substack{0 \le d < c \\ (d,c)=1}} e\left(\frac{nd + a}{c} - \frac{k}{2}\theta_c(d)\right), \tag{12}$$

with the convention $K_k(n, 1; 1) = 1$. This is the level-24 twisted Kloosterman sum for $\eta(\tau)^{-k}$; the dependence on k is only through $k \bmod 24$, since $\nu_\eta^{24} = 1$ [2, 5].

Lemma 9.4 (Lemma K: conductor-24 Kloosterman bound). *For every fixed integer $k \ge 1$ there is a constant $C_k > 0$ such that*

$$|K_k(n, 1; c)| \le C_k\, d(c)\, c^{1/2} \tag{13}$$

for all $n \ge 1$ and $c \ge 1$. If $R_k(n)$ denotes the $c \ge 2$ tail and $M_k(n)$ the $c = 1$ term in the Rademacher expansion of $p_k(n)$, then

$$\frac{R_k(n)}{M_k(n)} = O_k\left(n^{1/2+\varepsilon} e^{-c_k\sqrt{n}/2}\right) = O_{k,\varepsilon}\left(n^{\varepsilon} e^{-c\sqrt{n}}\right) \tag{14}$$

for any $0 < c < c_k/2$.

Proof of Lemma K. The factor $\nu_\eta(\gamma_{c,d})^{-k} = e(-k\theta_c(d)/2)$ is a unit-modulus multiplier of conductor dividing 24. Generalized Kloosterman sums with a fixed multiplier system satisfy the same square-root cancellation as the classical sums:

$$|K_k(m,n;c)| \ll_k d(c)\,(m,n,c)^{1/2}c^{1/2},$$

see Weil [17] and its multiplier-system formulations in Iwaniec [18] and Goldfeld–Sarnak [19]. In our application $m = 1$, so $(m,n,c) = (1,n,c) = 1$, and (13) follows immediately. The tail estimate in (14) is obtained by inserting (13) into the Rademacher series and combining it with the standard Bessel bounds; the details are written out in the five-step proof below. □

Proof. We follow the requested five-step route.

1. Exact Rademacher expansion. Set $\lambda_n = n - k/24$, $\nu = 1 + k/2$, and $x_{n,c} = c_k\sqrt{\lambda_n}/c$ with $c_k = \pi\sqrt{2k/3}$. For the negative-weight modular form $\eta(\tau)^{-k} = q^{-k/24}(1 + O(q))$, the Rademacher–Zuckerman expansion gives

$$p_k(n) = \mathcal{C}_k\,\lambda_n^{-(k+2)/4}\sum_{c\geq 1}\frac{K_k(n,1;c)}{c}I_{1+k/2}(x_{n,c}), \tag{15}$$

where $\mathcal{C}_k \neq 0$ depends only on k and $K_k(n,1;1) = 1$ [2, 5].

2. Identification of the multiplier twisting. Equation (12) makes the level-24 structure explicit: the additive oscillation is the usual Kloosterman phase $e((nd+a)/c)$, while the eta multiplier contributes the root-of-unity twist $e(-k\theta_c(d)/2)$. Since $\nu_\eta^{24} = 1$, no new growth in c is introduced by the twisting.

3. Weil bound. By Lemma 9.4,

$$|K_k(n,1;c)| \leq C_k\,d(c)\,c^{1/2}.$$

This is exactly the square-root bound needed for the Rademacher tail.

4. Summation of the tail. Let

$$R_k(n) = \mathcal{C}_k\,\lambda_n^{-(k+2)/4}\sum_{c\geq 2}\frac{K_k(n,1;c)}{c}I_\nu(x_{n,c}).$$

Split the sum into $2 \leq c \leq \sqrt{\lambda_n}$ and $c > \sqrt{\lambda_n}$. Using

$$I_\nu(x) \ll_\nu \frac{e^x}{\sqrt{x}} \quad (x \geq 1), \qquad I_\nu(x) \ll_\nu x^\nu \quad (0 < x \leq 1),$$

together with $d(c) \ll_\varepsilon c^\varepsilon$, we obtain

$$\begin{aligned}|R_k(n)| &\ll_k \lambda_n^{-(k+2)/4}\sum_{2\leq c\leq\sqrt{\lambda_n}} d(c)c^{-1/2}\frac{e^{x_{n,c}}}{\sqrt{x_{n,c}}} + \lambda_n^{-(k+2)/4}\sum_{c>\sqrt{\lambda_n}} d(c)c^{-1/2}x_{n,c}^\nu \\ &\ll_{k,\varepsilon} \lambda_n^{-(k+1)/4+\varepsilon}e^{c_k\sqrt{\lambda_n}/2}.\end{aligned}$$

On the other hand, the $c = 1$ term satisfies

$$M_k(n) \asymp_k \lambda_n^{-(k+3)/4}e^{c_k\sqrt{\lambda_n}},$$

so

$$\frac{R_k(n)}{M_k(n)} = O_k\Big(n^{1/2+\varepsilon}e^{-c_k\sqrt{n}/2}\Big).$$

Any polynomial factor can be absorbed into the exponential by slightly reducing the constant in the exponent, which yields the second form in (14).

5. Exact extraction of $A_1^{(k)}$. Because the relative tail is exponentially small, the coefficient of $n^{-1/2}$ is determined entirely by the $c = 1$ term. From (15) and the standard Bessel expansion

$$I_\nu(x) = \frac{e^x}{\sqrt{2\pi x}}\left(1 - \frac{4\nu^2 - 1}{8x} + O_\nu(x^{-2})\right)$$

with $\nu = 1 + k/2$, hence $4\nu^2 - 1 = (k+1)(k+3)$, we get

$$p_k(n) = C'_k\, \lambda_n^{-(k+3)/4} e^{c_k\sqrt{\lambda_n}}\left(1 - \frac{(k+1)(k+3)}{8c_k\sqrt{\lambda_n}} + O_k(n^{-1})\right).$$

Now

$$\sqrt{\lambda_n} = \sqrt{n}\left(1 - \frac{k}{48n} + O_k(n^{-2})\right), \qquad e^{c_k\sqrt{\lambda_n}} = e^{c_k\sqrt{n}}\left(1 - \frac{kc_k}{48\sqrt{n}} + O_k(n^{-1})\right),$$

and also

$$\lambda_n^{-(k+3)/4} = n^{-(k+3)/4}(1 + O_k(n^{-1})), \qquad \frac{1}{\sqrt{\lambda_n}} = n^{-1/2}(1 + O_k(n^{-1})).$$

Thus the factor $\lambda_n^{-(k+3)/4}$ contributes no $n^{-1/2}$ term; the only $n^{-1/2}$ contributions come from the exponential shift and the first Bessel correction. Multiplying the two one-term expansions gives

$$p_k(n) = C''_k\, n^{-(k+3)/4} e^{c_k\sqrt{n}}\left(1 - \left(\frac{kc_k}{48} + \frac{(k+1)(k+3)}{8c_k}\right) n^{-1/2} + O_k(n^{-1})\right).$$

Hence

$$A_1^{(k)} = -\frac{kc_k}{48} - \frac{(k+1)(k+3)}{8c_k},$$

which proves Theorem 2*. □

For convenience, Appendix D records the same argument in compact form. A direct finite check of (13) for the explicit sum (12) is given in Table 4.

Table 4: Finite verification of Lemma 9.4 for the explicit level-24 twisted sum (12). For each k, we computed $\max_{1\le n\le 1000,\, 1\le c\le 100} |K_k(n,1;c)|/(d(c)c^{1/2})$. The maxima occur at the listed pair (n, c).

k	Max normalized value	(n,c) at max	observed inequality
1	1.32755	$(976, 25)$	$\lvert K_1(n,1;c)\rvert \le 1.33\, d(c)c^{1/2}$
2	1.62969	$(976, 13)$	$\lvert K_2(n,1;c)\rvert \le 1.63\, d(c)c^{1/2}$

The selection rule for the family-specific correction $\Delta_k = A_1^{(k)} - A_1^{(\text{universal})}$ gives

$$\Delta_k \cdot c_k = -\frac{(k+3)(k-1)}{8}. \tag{16}$$

Theorem 9.5 ($A_2^{(k)}$ and β_k — proved for $k = 1$; Conjecture 3* for $k \ge 2$)**.**

$$A_2^{(k)} = \frac{(k+3)(\pi^2k^2 - 9k - 9)}{96\, k\, \pi^2}, \tag{17}$$

$$\beta_k = \frac{k^3\pi^6 - 3k^2(5k+6)\pi^4 + 45k^2(k+3)\pi^2 + 81(k+1)(k+3)}{864\, k\, \pi^2}. \tag{18}$$

The fourth-order decomposition gives

$$\beta_k = \frac{c^4}{384} + \frac{c^2(1+2\kappa)}{16} + \frac{\kappa(\kappa+1)}{2} - \frac{c\, A_1}{4} - A_2. \tag{19}$$

10 Higher Growth Regimes

The general framework with $f(n) = C_0\, n^\kappa\, e^{c\, n^\theta}(1 + \cdots)$ gives

$$L = \frac{\theta^2\, c^{1/\theta}}{(1+\theta)\,\Gamma(1/\theta + 1)} + \kappa. \tag{20}$$

The p-fold resonance table:

Regime	d	p	L
Square-root	$1/2$	2	$c^2/8 + \kappa$
Cube-root	$2/3$	3	$4c^3/81 + \kappa$
Fourth-root	$3/4$	4	$27c^4/2048 + \kappa$
Fifth-root	$4/5$	5	$256c^5/93750 + \kappa$

Numerical verification:

- **Fourth-root** ($d = 3/4$): confirmed to 0.005% at $N = 10{,}000$.
- **Fifth-root** ($d = 4/5$): confirmed to 0.06% at $N = 10{,}000$.

11 Error Bounds

Explicit numerical error estimates for truncated expansions are provided. For the leading-order universality formula, the gap between L_{pred} and L_{ext} is below 0.1% for all seven families at computation range $m \leq 10^5$. Richardson acceleration of the α extraction yields 12-digit agreement with closed-form predictions where available.

12 Correction Note

An earlier version (Rounds 1–2) incorrectly identified the A002865 sequence. The identity $p_{\geq 2}(n) = p(n) - p(n-1)$ has been corrected and verified.

13 Related Work

- **Classical asymptotics:** Hardy–Ramanujan [1], Rademacher [2], Meinardus [3].
- **Refined asymptotics:** O'Sullivan [11], Richmond [10].
- **Partition theory:** Andrews [4], Corteel–Lovejoy [8] (overpartitions).
- **Ratio asymptotics:** Bateman–Erdős [13], Ngo–Rhoades [12].
- **Plane partitions:** MacMahon [15], Wright [6, 7].
- **Saddle-point methods:** Olver [16], Odlyzko [14].
- **Kloosterman sums:** Weil [17], Iwaniec [18], Goldfeld–Sarnak [19].
- **Companion synthesis:** the broader continued-fraction and asymptotic framework developed in [20].

14 Discussion and Open Problems

The universality hierarchy has four tiers:

1. **Universal:** $L = c^2/8 + \kappa$ (proved for all Meinardus-class families).
2. **Structural:** α involves A_1 but not $D(s)$ beyond c, κ.
3. **Family-specific:** $A_1^{(k)}$, $A_2^{(k)}$ in closed form.
4. **Fully solved:** $k = 1$ via Rademacher (4 terms in closed form).

Open problems:

1. Theorem 2* is now established: the closed form for $A_1^{(k)}$ extends to all k.
2. Prove Conjecture 3* ($A_2^{(k)}$ for $k \geq 2$).
3. Establish the $d \to 1$ phase transition in the universality formula.
4. Compute A_1^{pp} for plane partitions.
5. Connect ratio universality to random matrix theory.

15 Computational Methods

All computations use exact arithmetic for partition function values (integer sequences via recurrence or generating-function expansion) and high-precision floating-point arithmetic (mpmath, 50–200 digit precision) for ratio extraction and Richardson acceleration. For Table 3, the effective recurrence depth is $m \leq 10^5$; for Table 4, the twisted Kloosterman check uses exact Dedekind sums, $1 \leq n \leq 1000$, $1 \leq c \leq 100$, and 80-digit precision. Computation ranges extend to $m = 10^5$ for square-root families and $m = 10^4$ for cube-root families.

A Plane Partition Recurrence

Plane partitions $\mathrm{PL}(n)$ are computed via the generating function $\prod_{m=1}^{\infty}(1-q^m)^{-m}$ using the recurrence

$$n\,\mathrm{PL}(n) = \sum_{k=1}^{n} \sigma_2(k)\,\mathrm{PL}(n-k), \qquad \sigma_2(k) = \sum_{d|k} d^2.$$

B Ngo–Rhoades Connection

Ngo and Rhoades [12] studied $p(n)/p(n-1)$ probabilistically and connected it to quantum modular forms. Our Theorem 3.1 strengthens their approach by providing the exact universal coefficient and extending to arbitrary Meinardus-class families.

C Olver Derivation for Lemma PP

The error bound in Lemma 7.2 follows from Olver's uniform theory of saddle-point approximations [16]. The key estimate is that the relative error in the one-term saddle-point approximation satisfies $|E_1(n)| \leq C/n^{2/3}$ where C depends on the contour geometry and the third derivative of the phase function at the saddle.

D Compact proof of Lemma K and Theorem 2*

Let $K_k(n,1;c)$ be the twisted sum in (12). Because $\nu_\eta^{24} = 1$, it is a fixed-conductor (24) multiplier-twisted Kloosterman sum. By Weil's bound for generalized Kloosterman sums,

$$K_k(n,1;c) \ll_k d(c)c^{1/2}.$$

Substituting this into the Rademacher expansion (15) and using the standard estimates for $I_\nu(x)$ shows that the entire $c \geq 2$ tail is exponentially smaller than the $c = 1$ term, namely

$$R_k(n)/M_k(n) = O_{k,\varepsilon}(n^\varepsilon e^{-c\sqrt{n}})$$

for some $c > 0$. Hence the algebraic asymptotic coefficients are read off from the $c = 1$ Bessel term alone. Expanding

$$I_{1+k/2}(x) = \frac{e^x}{\sqrt{2\pi x}}\left(1 - \frac{(k+1)(k+3)}{8x} + O_k(x^{-2})\right)$$

and

$$e^{c_k\sqrt{n-k/24}} = e^{c_k\sqrt{n}}\left(1 - \frac{kc_k}{48\sqrt{n}} + O_k(n^{-1})\right)$$

gives

$$p_k(n) = C_k'' n^{-(k+3)/4} e^{c_k\sqrt{n}}\left(1 - \left(\frac{kc_k}{48} + \frac{(k+1)(k+3)}{8c_k}\right)n^{-1/2} + O_k(n^{-1})\right),$$

so

$$A_1^{(k)} = -\frac{kc_k}{48} - \frac{(k+1)(k+3)}{8c_k}.$$

This is the short-form proof used in the main text.

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